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Verizon SuperPages

Report of Evidence of Use

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Patent Number: USUS7953416B2

Claim Number: (1

52. A process for dynamic routing of customer contacts to service providers via a telephone, comprising the steps of: establishing accounts for a plurality of service providers that provide non-telephonic -based services; permitting the plurality of service providers to bid against one another for a live telephone call based on a customer per-contact charge; creating a contact list comprised of the service providers ranked from the highest bidder service provider to the lowest bidder service provider; receiving a live telephone contact from a customer; routing the live telephone contact from the customer for a live conversation with the highest ranked bidder service provider on the contact list; and charging the service provider account receiving the live telephone contact the customer per-contact amount bid by the service provider.

Element 1:

52. A process for dynamic routing of customer contacts to service providers via a telephone, comprising the steps of:

Verizon's Superpages (yellow pages) provides a generic category ad with a local phone number. The ad and number will be different for each listing category. The categories include plumbing, taxi, etc. Call to that number is re-directed to a local advertiser in that category. From the figure attached, it is evident that the routing of a customer call happens dynamically to a local advertiser.

Ref 1: http://www.superpages.com/about/pressrelease/123.php

Ref 2: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2MA5rt97IU

Ref 3: http://certifiedknowledge.org/blog/verizon-offers-pay-per-call-solution/

Element 2:

establishing accounts for a plurality of service providers that provide non-telephonic -based services;

References from Verizon do not directly mention the back-end technology used by them. However, the ad mentions the usage of dynamically selecting the advertiser to whom a customer call will be directed. It also mentions about a bidding system that is updated daily. Depending on the category of the generic ad, advertisers pay at least $2 to $6 per call, but Verizon has seen bids reach $10 or $15. Hence, it is evident that there must be an online system present in the back-end which requires the advertisers to create online profiles for dynamic bidding per day. The references also mentions that the Verizon system is similar to Google Adwords which also require advertisers to create their online profile. However, please note that these are indicative references only.

Also, from the refence it is also clear that the servcies that is being advertised is related to plumbing, florists, etc, which are non-telephonic based services.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/ns/business-us_business/t/verizon-launches-google-like-advertising-model/#.V2PBKrt96Ul

Element 3:

permitting the plurality of service providers to bid against one another for a live telephone call based on a customer per-contact charge;

Multiple references suggest that the local advertiser to whom a customer originated call is being routed depends on who is the highest bidder for that particular day for that particular number. Hence, it is evident that multiple local advertisers bid against each other.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2MA5rt97lU

Ref 2: http://certifiedknowledge.org/blog/verizon-offers-pay-per-call-solution/

Ref 3: https://www.searchenginejournal.com/verizon-testing-pay-per-call-in-print-yellow-pages/3257/

Element 4:

creating a contact list comprised of the service providers ranked from the highest bidder service provider to the lowest bidder service provider;

One of the references states that the call routing in Verizon SuperPages generic ad, is handled by eStara Inc., which provides “click-to-call” services for Web sites, including Verizon’s online directory. The reference also states how a eStara keeps track of what companies a consumer calls through the generic numbers. If a consumer calls the “Taxi” number for the first time and is connected to, for instance, Cambridge Coach, Estara will route subsequent calls by that consumer to Cambridge Coach even if it is no longer the high bidder for the number. This gives an indication that a list of service providers is created in the back-end, where the list also contains their bid for that particular generic ad.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2PRd7t96Ul

Element 5:

receiving a live telephone contact from a customer;

The generic number provided on the Verizon Superpages ad is the number that a customer calls to get a service like taxi service, locksmiths etc. Estara handles the call routing of the generic number ads provided by Verizon.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2MA5rt97IU

Ref 2: http://certifiedknowledge.org/blog/verizon-offers-pay-per-call-solution/

Ref 3: https://www.searchenginejournal.com/verizon-testing-pay-per-call-in-print-yellow-pages/3257/

Element 6:

routing the live telephone contact from the customer for a live conversation with the highest ranked bidder service provider on the contact list; and

Multiple references indicate that Estara handles the call routing of generic number ad by Verizon. Also, as per Robyn Rose, vice president of Internet marketing for Verizon Superpages.com, call to the generic ad number is routed to a highest bidder for that ad for that particular day.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2MA5rt97IU

Ref 2: http://certifiedknowledge.org/blog/verizon-offers-pay-per-call-solution/

Ref 3: https://www.searchenginejournal.com/verizon-testing-pay-per-call-in-print-yellow-pages/3257/

Element 7:

charging the service provider account receiving the live telephone contact the customer per-contact amount bid by the service provider.

Verizon's system charges the advertiser to whom the call is being routed as per the bid amount selected by him.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/ns/business-us_business/t/verizon-launches-google-like-advertising-model/#.V2PBKrt96Ul

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Non-Disclosure Agreement:

We understand that for the purpose of assisting you in collecting data, you may disclose to us certain confidential information that you want to keep confidential; therefore, for good and valuable consideration, the receipt and sufficiency of which is hereby acknowledged, we agree as follows:

1. For a period of twelve (36) months from the date we receive your confidential information ("Effective Date"), we will not use or disclose the information, except: (a) in the event that such information (i) comes into the public domain not through us; (ii) is already known to us at the time of disclosure; (iii) is lawfully otherwise learnt or independently developed by us; or (iv) is required to be disclosed by law.

2. Since a breach of our obligations hereunder may result in irreparable harm to you, we agree that upon such breach or threat thereof, you shall be entitled to specific performance and other injunctive relief without posting a bond, and in the event of disclosures required by court order, we shall promptly notify you of the proceeding.

3. This agreement supersedes all prior discussions and writings and constitutes the entire agreement between you and us with respect to the subject matter hereof. This Agreement shall be binding upon the successors and assigns of the respective parties, and may not be modified except by an instrument executed by both parties.

Pankaj Mukhopadhyay